AADS Official Rules of Play

Official Publication of the Atlantic Amateur Darts Series (AADS)

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Section 1: Introduction and Definitions

1. Forward

This document represents the official **Rules of Play for the Atlantic Amateur Darts Series (AADS)** and shall be binding upon all participants, officials, and organizers involved in any event sanctioned or administered by the AADS. These rules are promulgated to ensure the highest standards of fair competition, integrity, and sportsmanship across the series.

2. Definitions

- **AADS:** Refers to the Atlantic Amateur Darts Series, the governing body sanctioning all events detailed herein.
- **Oche:** The designated toe-line or throwing boundary from which a player must project their darts. The player's physical stance must be maintained entirely behind its forward edge.
- **Dartboard:** A standard competition dartboard, typically constructed of compressed sisal fibre, meeting all regulatory dimensions specified in Section 6.
- **Throw:** A completed turn, uniformly comprising the projection of three individual darts, unless the conditions for concluding the Leg are met with fewer than three darts.
- **Leg:** A single, complete game unit. It commences at a predetermined numerical score (e.g.,) and concludes when one player achieves a valid Double-Out checkout.
- **Set:** A formalized collection of Legs, requiring a predetermined number of successful Leg completions by a player to achieve the overall Set victory.
- **Bust:** The condition that occurs when a player's score from a Throw results in an amount greater than the remaining score required to achieve a valid checkout, or results in a score of "" remaining.
- **Official:** Any individual designated and authorized by the AADS to oversee competition, including the Tournament Director, Referee, Marker, or Chalker.

4. AADS Code of Conduct

Mandatory compliance with the established AADS Code of Conduct is a prerequisite for all participants in sanctioned events. Any behavior or action determined by an Official to be detrimental to the competitive integrity of the sport, injurious to the reputation of the Atlantic Amateur Darts Series, or fundamentally contrary to the tenets of fair play and professionalism will subject the participant to immediate and severe disciplinary review. Such actions may include, but are not limited to, instant match forfeiture, event disqualification, and the imposition of long-term sanctions by the AADS disciplinary committee.

Section 2: The Setup

5. Specifications of Playing Equipment

5.1 Darts utilized in AADS competition are subject to strict dimensional and mass limitations. Specifically, the overall length of a dart shall not exceed **centimeters (inches)**, and the total mass must not exceed **grams**. Each complete dart assembly must fundamentally comprise a distinct point, barrel, and flight system.

5.2 The designated Official retains the unequivocal right to mandate the modification or replacement of a player's darts or any auxiliary playing equipment if, in the Official's professional assessment, said equipment is deemed either hazardous to players or spectators or fails to conform to standard, recognized, and orthodox design principles.

5.3 A 'Throw,' which constitutes a single turn, shall uniformly consist of the projection of precisely three darts by the player.

6. Dartboards and Lighting Configuration

6.1 All dartboards used in AADS competition shall be of the standard inch diameter, manufactured from sisal, and conform precisely to the internationally recognized "Clock" pattern and segment topology.

6.2 The double segment must be vertically oriented at the apex (top) of the board and shall be uniformly coloured red for visual distinction.

6.3 The official dimensional tolerances shall be maintained as follows:

- Double and Treble scoring sections: mm wide.
- Inner bullseye (double bull): mm diameter.
- Outer bullseye (single bull): mm diameter.

6.4 The dartboard shall be fixed in such a manner that the horizontal plane passing through the exact center of the bullseye is positioned precisely **meters (ft in.)** above the level of the surrounding floor surface.

6.5 The dartboard must be professionally illuminated by a system of one or more lamps specifically engineered to eliminate the casting of shadows across the playing surface. The minimum requisite illumination intensity measured at the face of the board shall be **lux**.

7. Oches (Toe-lines) and Throwing Stance

7.1 The minimum measured distance from the vertical plane of the dartboard's face to the forward edge of the Oche shall be precisely **meters (ft in.)**.

7.2 The Oche itself must be a physical, raised barrier with a minimum height of cm and a

minimum width of cm, and must be rigorously aligned to be perfectly centralized with the vertical median of the dartboard.

7.3 When executing a Throw, a player's stance is subject to the rule that both feet must be positioned entirely behind the front plane of the Oche. No part of either foot may transgress the forward edge of the throwing line.

7.4 A player is prohibited from leaning, stretching, or placing any portion of their foot, footwear, or person past the front edge of the Oche during the act of projecting a dart. Initial violations will result in a formal warning from the Official, and any subsequent, repeated offenses during the same match will regrettably result in the **forfeiture of the current game**.

Section 3: Gameplay Rules

8. Playing Area Demarcation

During the active duration of any match, the playing area is strictly restricted to the two actively participating players and the designated Official (Referee/Marker). All other individuals, including coaches and spectators, must remain outside this restricted zone. The designated minimum boundary for the playing area shall extend horizontally **meters (feet)** to both the left and right sides of the centrally-positioned Oche.

9. Execution of the Throw

9.1 All darts must be projected solely by hand, utilizing an individual and separate throwing motion for each dart. Mechanical assistance or unorthodox throwing devices are strictly disallowed.

9.4 Any physical contact initiated by a player with any dart already embedded in the dartboard, or with any darts remaining in the player's possession for that turn, prior to the Official explicitly announcing the total score, shall immediately signal the conclusion of that Throw. Consequently, any unthrown darts remaining for that specific turn shall be irrevocably forfeited, and only the score for darts already recorded will be counted.

10. Official Scoring Protocol

10.1 A dart shall be credited with a score only if its point is securely embedded in the playing surface and demonstrably remains fixed for a minimum duration of **five (5) seconds** after the third dart of the Throw has been released by the player.

10.5 Darts must be physically retrieved from the dartboard only after the Official has visibly and verbally confirmed the score for that specific Throw and has recorded it onto the scorecard.

10.9 Any dispute or challenge regarding the accuracy of the recorded score must be raised immediately by the player *before* the subsequent player initiates their Throw by projecting their first dart. No protest concerning a score shall be entertained or reviewed once the next player has commenced their throw.

10.10 **The "Bust" Rule:** If a player's Throw results in a total score that exceeds the precise numerical amount required to conclude the game (a **"bust"**), the player's score will be reverted to the total existing prior to that Throw. The score from the 'bust' Throw shall be annulled, and the player shall forfeit the remainder of that turn.

11. Mandatory Start and Finish Requirements

11.1 All competitive legs must be initiated and concluded with a throw landing in a **double segment**. For the purpose of starting and finishing, the inner Bullseye ring shall be officially recognized and scored as the Double .

11.2 The exact numerical format (e.g., , , or Cricket) and the sequence of legs and sets for any specific match or tournament will be determined and formally announced by the Tournament Director prior to the commencement of play.

15. Determination of Throwing Order

15.1 The player initiating the first leg of a match shall be determined through a preliminary **Bull-Off** competition (closest to the Bullseye). The winner of the Bull-Off is granted the strategic choice of throwing either first or second in that opening leg.

15.3 Following the initial leg, the right to commence the subsequent leg shall automatically alternate between the two players. Specifically, the player who did not throw first in the immediately preceding leg will commence the next one.

15.4 In matches contested under a "Set" format, the right to start the ultimate, deciding set shall revert to the Bull-Off procedure as defined in Rule .

16. Resolution of Tie Breakers

In any competitive scenario where the result of a match or set necessitates a tie-breaking leg (a **"deciding leg"**), the method for determining the order of throw for that crucial final leg must strictly adhere to the procedures stipulated in **Section 15 (Order of Play)**, which generally mandates a renewed Bull-Off.

Section 4: Tournament Administration

12. Tournament Administration Protocol

12.1 Every AADS-sanctioned tournament shall be professionally managed and administered by a designated Tournament Director (TD). The TD's judgment and interpretation of all rules shall be absolute and conclusive for the duration of the event.

12.3 All registered players are required to report to their assigned board promptly upon being called for their match. A failure to present oneself and be prepared to commence play within a pre-determined, reasonable time frame (typically **five minutes**) may regrettably result in the **forfeiture** of the match in favor of the opponent.

13. Entry Submission and Registration Requirements

All official entry forms must be completed in their entirety, providing accurate and verifiable information. Furthermore, the mandatory entry fee must be remitted in full prior to the published registration deadline. Any deliberate misrepresentation or falsification of player details on the entry form will be treated as a serious breach of integrity, resulting in immediate and non-appealable disqualification from the event and potential long-term bans.

14. Procedures for Draws, Match Formats, and Time Constraints

The process for generating the match draw shall be conducted transparently under the direct supervision of the Tournament Director, and the resulting bracket shall be considered final and binding. The specific competitive format (e.g., Best-of-Five Legs, Single Elimination) and any associated time restrictions for match completion will be formally communicated to all participants prior to the start of the tournament proceedings.

17. Practice Session Limitations

Prior to the official commencement of an assigned match, each competing player shall be strictly limited to a maximum of **nine (9) practice darts** on the designated match board. Once the first dart of the official match has been thrown, the use of the match board for any further practice is unequivocally forbidden until the conclusion of the match.

18. Protocol for Power Interruption and Emergency Evacuation

In the unfortunate event of a power failure, emergency situation, or mandatory venue evacuation, the Tournament Director is charged with the immediate cessation of all match play. Should the conditions permit a resumption of the tournament, all interrupted matches shall recommence precisely from the **exact score and dart count** at the moment the interruption was officially declared, thereby preserving the competitive status quo.

Section 5: Player Conduct

19. Official Playing Attire and Headgear Policy

All competing players are required to adhere strictly to the AADS official dress code, which generally mandates business-casual attire (e.g., collared shirts, dark tailored trousers or skirts, and closed-toe footwear). The wearing of headgear (including caps and hats) is strictly prohibited within the playing arena unless specific exemption has been formally granted by the Tournament Director for documented medical or religious requirements.

20. Regulation of Player Advertising

Any commercial sponsorship logos, brand markings, or promotional advertising intended for display on a player's clothing or equipment during an AADS-sanctioned event must receive prior written authorization and formal approval from the AADS administrative body. Unauthorized advertising is grounds for immediate request for removal or disciplinary action.

21. Prohibition of Intoxicants and Tobacco Products

The use of tobacco products (including e-cigarettes and vaping devices) and the consumption of alcoholic beverages or controlled narcotics is rigorously prohibited immediately preceding or during the duration of any official match. Any player exhibiting signs of intoxication or impairment that could adversely affect their performance or the integrity of the match, as determined by an Official, shall be subject to immediate disqualification without recourse.

22. Disciplinary Protocol

All punitive and disciplinary actions resulting from violations of these rules or the AADS Code of Conduct shall be conducted with due process and strictly in accordance with the established AADS Code of Practice on Disciplinary Proceedings.

Section 6: Official Business

3. Enforcement

The designated Tournament Director (TD) shall serve as the ultimate authority in all matters concerning the interpretation and practical application of these official Rules of Play during an AADS sanctioned event. The TD's rulings on disputes, technical interpretations, and disciplinary actions are final and absolute for the duration of the tournament.

23. Amendments and Revisions Authority

The Atlantic Amateur Darts Series (AADS) explicitly reserves the unilateral right to revise, amend, or add to any and all of these official AADS Playing Rules as deemed necessary for the betterment and governance of the sport.

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